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ARTICLE

Vanishing Support For Israel: How Propaganda Rewrote Reality



BY PNW STAFF JULY 08, 2026

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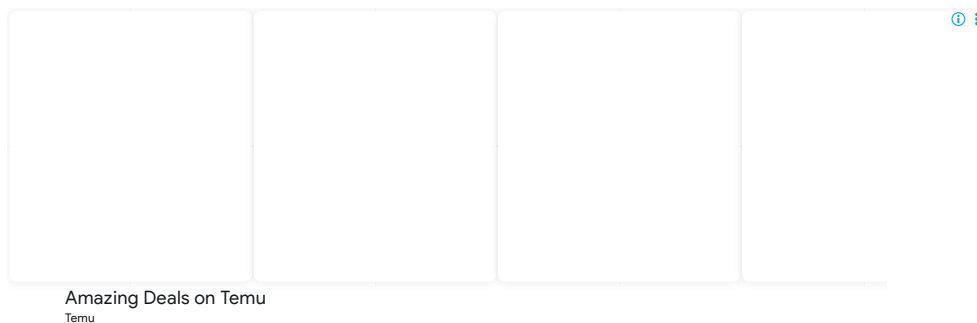
There are few examples in modern history that better demonstrate the power of propaganda than the dramatic shift in American opinion toward Israel.

Less than two years ago, the civilized world watched in horror as Hamas terrorists stormed across Israel's border, massacring approximately 1,200 people, burning families alive, raping women, kidnapping children, and livestreaming their atrocities. The attack shocked the conscience of the world.

Yet today, millions of Americans--particularly younger Americans--have become convinced that Israel, not Hamas, is the villain. Poll after poll now shows support for Israel steadily declining across nearly every demographic, including among younger Republicans and even younger Evangelical Christians.

What happened?

The old saying remains true: Tell a lie often enough, and people will believe it.



The "Genocide" Narrative

Perhaps no accusation has spread faster than the claim that Israel is committing genocide in Gaza.

The word itself carries enormous emotional power. It evokes images of the Holocaust, Rwanda, Cambodia, and systematic attempts to exterminate an entire people.

But does it fit Gaza?

The facts suggest otherwise.

If Israel were attempting genocide, it would arguably be the least effective genocide in military history.

The Palestinian population has not collapsed--it has grown dramatically over the past several decades. Even during the conflict, demographic projections continue to show long-term population growth rather than extermination.

More importantly, Israel's military campaign has produced one of the lowest civilian-to-combatant casualty ratios ever recorded in urban warfare according to numerous military analysts.

Former commanders and urban warfare experts--including John Spencer of the Modern War Institute at West Point--have argued that despite fighting in one of the most densely populated battlefields on Earth against an enemy deliberately embedded among civilians, Israel has achieved a civilian casualty ratio that compares favorably with recent conflicts in Iraq, Afghanistan, Mosul, and Raqqa.

Why?

Because Israel has repeatedly used methods almost unheard of in warfare:

- * Advance evacuation warnings.
- * Millions of leaflets.
- * Text messages.
- * Phone calls.
- * "Roof knocking" warning munitions.
- * Humanitarian corridors.
- * Temporary pauses in fighting.

No military can eliminate civilian casualties when the opposing force intentionally hides inside schools, hospitals, mosques, apartment buildings, and refugee camps.

Hamas openly admits this strategy.



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Who Is Counting The Dead?

Another uncomfortable reality rarely discussed is the source of the casualty figures dominating international headlines.

Nearly every major media outlet relies primarily upon statistics released by Gaza's Health Ministry.

That ministry is controlled by Hamas.

While many reports acknowledge this fact in passing, headlines often present the numbers as though they were independently verified.

Even more significant, Hamas' casualty reports generally do not distinguish between civilians and combatants.

A 17-year-old Hamas fighter carrying an RPG and a 6-year-old child are frequently counted within the same overall total.

That distinction matters enormously.

The ministry has also faced repeated credibility questions throughout the war.

Early in the conflict, Hamas claimed an Israeli airstrike killed roughly 500 people at Gaza's Al-Ahli Hospital. Within days, U.S., European, and independent intelligence assessments concluded the explosion was most likely caused by a failed Palestinian Islamic Jihad rocket and that the casualty count had been dramatically overstated.

Researchers have also identified anomalies in reported casualty lists, including duplicate identities, inconsistent demographic patterns, and statistical irregularities that raised questions about the reliability of some published data.

None of this means every reported death is false.

It does mean the numbers should be treated with caution--not accepted uncritically as unquestionable fact.

The Social Media War

For many younger Americans, TikTok has become more influential than history books.

Thirty-second emotional videos rarely explain Hamas' decades-long commitment to Israel's destruction, its charter calling for Israel's elimination, or its systematic use of human shields.

Algorithms reward outrage--not context.

Graphic images circulate instantly while military realities disappear behind emotionally charged slogans.

The result is a generation increasingly convinced that good and evil are reversed.

Even Christians Are Losing Their Bearings

Perhaps most troubling is the growing shift among younger Evangelicals.

Surveys show support for Israel declining sharply among Christians under 40.

Part of this reflects a broader problem inside the modern church: biblical illiteracy.

Many Christians simply do not understand God's repeated covenant promises concerning Israel throughout Scripture.

Whether discussing the Abrahamic Covenant, the prophets, or the prophetic events described in Ezekiel, Zechariah, Romans, and Revelation, Israel occupies a central place in God's redemptive plan.

That does not mean Israel's government is beyond criticism.

No nation is.

But rejecting Israel altogether reflects a misunderstanding of both biblical history and biblical prophecy.

Many younger Christians are also influenced more by social media personalities than by careful Bible study.

Some conservative commentators who built their reputations challenging establishment narratives have become increasingly critical of Israel. Figures such as Tucker Carlson and Candace Owens have shaped opinions among millions of younger conservatives, leading some to adopt sweeping conclusions that

often omit Hamas' ideology, Iran's regional ambitions, or Israel's unique security realities.

Healthy skepticism toward governments is valuable.

But skepticism must be applied consistently--not selectively.

Truth Still Matters

The decline in support for Israel should concern anyone who values truth over propaganda.

History repeatedly shows how quickly public opinion can be manipulated when emotionally compelling narratives replace careful examination of facts.

Israel is not perfect.

Its leaders make mistakes.

Its military operations deserve scrutiny like those of any democracy.

But criticism built upon false premises ultimately serves neither Israelis nor Palestinians.

Christians especially should resist forming opinions based on viral videos, selective statistics, or ideological influencers. Scripture repeatedly calls believers to love truth, test every claim, and exercise discernment.

In an age where algorithms shape perception and slogans often triumph over evidence, perhaps the greatest battlefield is no longer Gaza.

It is the human mind.

And whoever wins that battle often determines how history itself is remembered.

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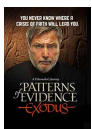
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